

HOW TO MAKE “POPPING” SPHERES

Spherification is the culinary process of shaping liquids into spheres. This molecular gastronomy technique has now made its way to the popular world of bubble tea, and can be used to experiment with a wide range of juices and teas to create “popping” spheres, or bubbles, to use instead of traditional tapioca.

YOU WILL NEED

Ingredients

6g sodium alginate powder

¼oz (10g) calcium chloride powder

juices, tisanes, or teas to flavor the alginate

Special equipment

handheld blender

syringe or squeeze bottle



1 In a deep bowl, add the sodium alginate to 2¾ cups water. Blend for 5–10 minutes. Transfer to a 2-quart cooking pot and bring to a boil. Remove from the heat and transfer back to the bowl to cool completely.

2 In a separate bowl, mix 2 parts juice or strong tea with 3 parts cooled alginate. In another deep bowl, dissolve the calcium chloride in 2 quarts of water by stirring for 1–2 minutes; this will create a colorless liquid.

You could reduce the quantities in the recipe by half if you don't want to spend too much time making spheres.



3 Using a syringe or squeeze bottle, release droplets of the alginate mixture into the bowl containing the calcium chloride solution, one drop at a time.

4 Remove the spheres with a slotted spoon. Serve immediately as they will solidify within a few hours. Pour 2 cups tea of your choice into 2 tumblers and add one-quarter of the popping spheres to each.